Survey to mission chiefs IMF Advice on Fiscal Policy (FP) During 2021-23

The following question(s) ask about certain demographic data that will be used to analyze the results. As a reminder, **your responses are confidential and will remain anonymous**. Results will be aggregated and not attributed to specific people.

The following question(s) ask about certain demographic data that will be used to analyze the results. As a reminder, **your responses are confidential and will remain anonymous**. Results will be aggregated and not attributed to specific people.

The survey covers the period 2021-23.

* 1. Which of the following describes your current grade in the IMF?

- ○ A12 – A13
- ○ A14 – A15
- ○ B1 – B3
- ○ B4 – B5

Document was last saved: Just now

* 2. Please answer the survey based on the country you were Mission Chief (MC) of during most of 2021-23. If you were MC for more than one country during that period, choose one. Please indicate the country on which you are basing your responses.

Type to filter

* 3. When providing fiscal policy advice to the country, did you have access to guidance (e.g., in the form of a guidance note, internal memos) on?

	No guidance	Some guidance	Extensive guidance	Don't know	Not applicable
* Fiscal rules and institutions	○	○	○	○	○
* Security/military spending	○	○	○	○	○
* Public debt management	○	○	○	○	○
* Fiscal policy issues specific to the country grouping the country belonged (e.g., Advanced Economies, Emerging Markets, LICs, commodity exporter)	○	○	○	○	○

4. When providing fiscal policy advice to the country, to what extent did you verify whether bilateral fiscal policy advice given to the country was consistent with messages voiced in flagship publications, speeches, blogs, and management's public statements?

- ○ Never
- ○ Minimally
- ○ Somewhat
- ○ Significantly

[Questions 4.1 and 4.2 appear only if the answer to question 4 is either "somewhat" or "significantly"]

* 4.1. When such fiscal policy advice was not consistent, did you explain to country authorities why advice was not consistent with multilateral fiscal policy advice messages (e.g., in flagship publications and other public statements)?

- ○ Never
- ○ Less than 50% of the time
- ○ 50% of the time or more
- ○ Always
- ○ Don't know

* 4.2. When such fiscal policy advice was not consistent, was this because multilateral fiscal policy advice messages (e.g., in flagship publications and other public statements) were not sufficiently tailored to country-specific circumstances?

- ◯ Never
- ◯ Less than 50% of the time
- ◯ 50% of the time or more
- ◯ Always
- ◯ Don't know

* 5. Based on your experience providing fiscal policy advice in the member country:

	Never	Less than 50% of the time	50% of the time or more	Always	Don't know
* Did fiscal policy advice identify the key issues, trends, and risks?	○	○	○	○	○
* Was fiscal policy advice candid?	○	○	○	○	○
* Was fiscal policy advice timely?	○	○	○	○	○
* Did fiscal policy advice take into account country authorities' perspectives?	○	○	○	○	○
* Was fiscal policy advice sufficiently tailored to country-specific circumstances?	○	○	○	○	○
* Did fiscal policy advice take into account other policy areas (e.g., monetary policy, financial stability)	○	○	○	○	○
* Did fiscal policy advice consider tradeoffs between first-best and second-best approaches?	○	○	○	○	○
* Did fiscal policy advice explain the rationale behind their fiscal advice?	○	○	○	○	○
* Did fiscal policy advice take into account political economy constraints?	○	○	○	○	○
* Did fiscal policy advice take into account administrative and other capacity constraints?	○	○	○	○	○
* Was fiscal policy advice evenhanded?	○	○	○	○	○
* Did fiscal policy advice promote conditions that, under realistic assumptions, would support longer-term economic sustainability?	○	○	○	○	○

* 6. When IMF fiscal policy advice was not acted upon by the authorities, what was the reason?
Select all that apply.

- [ ] Fund "leverage" outside of program relationships is too limited
- [ ] Political realities made implementation difficult or undesirable
- [ ] Fund advice wasn't time sensitive (e.g., no immediate need to respond)
- [ ] Fund staff didn't have access to policymakers at the appropriate level
- [ ] The analysis provided by staff failed to convince the authorities
- [ ] Don't know
- [ ] Doesn't apply (i.e., the authorities did act on the advice)
- [ ] Other (please specify)

Short-term advice

7. In the advice on the size and pace of **fiscal stimulus**, what factors were taken into account?
Select all that apply.

- [ ] Trade-off between sustainability and growth
- [ ] Initial cyclical conditions (e.g., output gap, inflation, unemployment)
- [ ] Financing constraints (e.g., market pressures, rollover risk, and financing needs)
- [ ] Policy mix considerations (e.g., coordination between fiscal and monetary policy)
- [ ] Outward spillovers
- [ ] Inward spillovers
- [ ] External sustainability (e.g., external debt sustainability analysis, current account position)
- [ ] Fiscal risks
- [ ] Fiscal multipliers
- [ ] Fiscal space
- [ ] Don't know
- [ ] Not applicable
- [ ] Other (please specify)

8. In the IMF recommendations on the appropriateness and size of **fiscal adjustment**, what factors were taken into account?

Select all that apply.

- [ ] Trade-off between sustainability and growth
- [ ] Initial cyclical conditions (e.g., output gap, inflation, unemployment)
- [ ] Financing constraints (e.g., market pressures, rollover risk, and financing needs)
- [ ] Policy mix considerations (e.g., coordination between fiscal and monetary policy)
- [ ] Outward spillovers
- [ ] Inward spillovers
- [ ] External sustainability (e.g., external debt sustainability analysis, current account position)
- [ ] Fiscal risks
- [ ] Fiscal multipliers
- [ ] Fiscal space
- [ ] Don't know
- [ ] Not applicable
- [ ] Other (please specify)

[question 8.1 appears only if respondent chooses “fiscal risks” in either question 7 or question 8]

8.1 If fiscal risks were discussed, what risks were discussed?
Select all that apply.

- [ ] Contingent liabilities (e.g., from state-owned enterprises or financial sector)
- [ ] Macroeconomic uncertainty
- [ ] Policy implementation risk
- [ ] Capacity implementation risk
- [ ] Debt composition and/or debt maturity
- [ ] Fiscal risks were not discussed
- [ ] Don't know
- [ ] Not applicable
- [ ] Other (please specify)

9. Did the authorities agree with Fund's fiscal policy advice for the short term?

- ◯ Never
- ◯ Less than 50 percent of the time
- ◯ At least 50 percent of the time
- ◯ Yes, always
- ◯ Don't know
- ◯ Not applicable

Medium-term advice

10. In your engagement with the country's authorities, was there an assessment of and advice on the medium-term fiscal challenges and outlook?

- (●) Yes, in detail
- ( ) Partially
- ( ) No
- ( ) Don't know

10.1. How well was this integrated in the short-term fiscal policy analysis and recommendations?

- ( ) Little or not at all
- ( ) Partially
- ( ) Well integrated
- ( ) Don't know

[Question 10.1 appears only if answer to Q10 is either “Yes in detail”, or “Partially”]

11. To what extent were medium-term fiscal anchors discussed?

- ◯ Little or not at all
- ◯ Partially
- ◯ Extensively
- ◯ Don't know

12. Did the authorities agree with Fund's fiscal policy advice for the medium term?

- ◯ Never
- ◯ Less than 50 percent of the time
- ◯ At least 50 percent of the time
- ◯ Yes, always
- ◯ Don't know
- ◯ Not applicable

Capacity Development (CD)

* 13. If the country you were Mission Chief of received training and/or technical assistance on fiscal policy, was it integrated with the fiscal policy advice under surveillance?

- ◯ Well integrated (e.g., CD activities provided good support to implementation of the fiscal policy advice)
- ◯ Partially integrated (e.g., CD activities provided some support to implementation of the fiscal policy advice)
- ◯ Not integrated (e.g., CD did not provide any support to implementation of the fiscal policy advice)
- ◯ Country did not receive CD
- ◯ Don't know
- ◯ Not applicable

* 14. Did a FAD economist or expert join your country team for missions in the context of Art. IV consultations?

- ◯ Yes, all the time
- ◯ Yes, more than 50% of the time
- ◯ Yes, less than 50% of the time
- ◯ No, never
- ◯ Don't know
- ◯ Not applicable

Areas of More Recent Fund Engagement and SDGs

15. When the Fund provided fiscal policy advice in your country in the context of an Article IV Consultation or a Fund-supported program, did it discuss the following:

	Little or not at all	Partially	Extensively	Don't know	Not applicable
* How to protect the most vulnerable, even where there is a need for fiscal adjustment, and leave or create fiscal space for social spending, if needed?	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
* How to create fiscal space for climate change mitigation/adaptation?	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
* How fiscal policy can help achieve better gender outcomes?	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
* How fiscal policy can help achieve Sustainable Development Goals--SDGs (if relevant)?	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯